Course Code LA101

Name: Communication Skills, Strategies and Protocol

Desccription: It will equip learners with skills of business writing and presentation skill enabling them with skills for conveying evidence backed information clearly and concisely. The course will cover contents for composing business content, organizing data, creating presentations, and team-building, to mention but a few

Rational: This course intends to equip learners with vital communication skills, protocol knowledge, and adaptability across diverse contexts. It will empower them to communicate effectively, navigate various situations, handle crises transparently, excel in leadership roles, manage digital challenges, and maintain ethical and cultural sensitivity in their interactions.

Objective:

Main Objective

By the end of the course-tenure the students should be able to:

- Develop strong communication skills, including verbal and written communication, public speaking, and active listening.
- Understand and apply etiquette and protocol in various settings, such as business, dining, cross-cultural, and digital contexts.
- Navigate different communication contexts, including personal relationships, healthcare, legal, and sales, with confidence.
- Handle crisis communication effectively, using transparency, ethical principles, and media relations strategies.
- Build trust and credibility in leadership roles, provide constructive feedback, and resolve conflicts adeptly.
- Maintain online professionalism, cybersecurity, and ethical online communication practices in the digital age.
- Cultivate cultural sensitivity and respect diverse perspectives while upholding ethical communication standards

Content:

Unit 1: Introduction to Communication Skills and Protocol

- Definition and models of communication:
  - Linear model.
  - Interactive model.
  - Transactional model.
- The communication process:
  - Sender, message, receiver.
  - Encoding and decoding.
  - Feedback.
- The role of context and audience in communication.

- Importance of clear objectives in communication.
- Consequences of poor communication and protocol breaches:
    - Misunderstandings.
    - Conflict.
    - Damage to reputation.
    - Legal implications.

Unit 2: Verbal Communication Skills

- Effective verbal communication:
    - Clarity and precision.
    - Conciseness.
    - Active voice.
    - Avoiding jargon.
- The power of words and vocabulary:
    - Word choice and impact.
    - Building a strong vocabulary.
- Voice modulation and pitch:
    - Expressing emotions through voice.
    - Pitch, tone, and volume control.
- Overcoming speech anxiety:
    - Public speaking fears.
    - Techniques for reducing anxiety.
- Techniques for persuasive communication:
    - Ethos, pathos, logos.
    - Persuasive language and rhetoric.
- Interpersonal communication skills:
    - Building rapport.
    - Empathy and active listening.
    - Conflict resolution.

Unit 3: Non-Verbal Communication

- Understanding the significance of non-verbal cues:
    - Role in conveying emotions and attitudes.
    - Complementing verbal messages.
- Types of non-verbal communication:
    - Body language (gestures, postures, facial expressions).
    - Paralanguage (tone of voice, pace, volume).
    - Proxemics (personal space).
    - Haptics (touch).
- Cultural differences in non-verbal communication:
    - Variations in gestures and facial expressions.
    - Importance of cultural sensitivity.
- How to project confidence through non-verbal cues:
    - Positive body language.
    - Maintaining eye contact.
- Using non-verbal communication to enhance verbal messages:
    - Reinforcing messages with gestures and expressions.
    - Aligning non-verbal cues with the intended message.

Unit 4: Written Communication

- Elements of effective written communication:
    - Clarity and coherence.

- Organization and structure.
- Grammar and punctuation.

- Business correspondence (emails, memos, letters):
  - Formal vs. informal communication.
  - Writing professional emails.
  - Memo formatting and content.
  - Business letter structure.
- Structuring and formatting written documents:
  - Reports and proposals.
  - Academic papers.
- Proofreading and editing techniques:
  - Common proofreading errors.
  - Self-editing strategies.
- Adapting writing style to different audiences:
  - Tailoring language to readers' preferences and expectations.
  - Avoiding biased language.
- Avoiding common writing errors:
  - Run-on sentences, fragments, and subject-verb agreement.
  - Misplaced modifiers.

Unit 5: Digital Communication and Netiquette

- Digital communication tools and platforms:
  - Email, chat, video conferencing, social media.
- Email etiquette and best practices:
  - Subject lines, greetings, and sign-offs.
  - Managing email overload.
  - Responding promptly and professionally.
- Online professionalism and reputation management:
  - Digital footprint.
  - Social media professionalism.
- Social media communication strategies:
  - Creating engaging content.
  - Building a personal or professional brand.
  - Responding to online criticism.
- Netiquette in online forums and communities:
  - Rules of online forums.
  - Respecting diverse opinions.
- Virtual meeting and video conferencing etiquette:
  - Camera and microphone usage.
  - Managing interruptions.
  - Engaging in virtual meetings effectively.

Unit 6: Protocol and Etiquette in Various Settings

- Business etiquette in a professional setting:
  - Office etiquette (punctuality, attire).
  - Meeting etiquette (agenda, participation).
  - Professional introductions.
- Dining etiquette and table manners:
  - Formal vs. informal dining.
  - Place settings and utensil usage.
  - Table conversation and behavior.

- Dress codes and appearance in different contexts:
    - Corporate dress codes.
    - Casual vs. formal attire.
    - Personal grooming and hygiene.
- Communication protocol in international and cross-cultural contexts:
    - Cultural communication norms.
    - Avoiding cultural misunderstandings.
    - Language considerations.
- Protocol for public speaking engagements:
    - Preparing for a speech.
    - Delivery techniques.
    - Handling Q&A sessions.
- Handling conflict and difficult conversations with diplomacy:
    - Conflict resolution strategies.
    - Active listening in conflict situations.
    - Constructive feedback.

Unit 7: Crisis Communication

- Understanding the principles of crisis communication:
    - Importance of transparency.
    - Crisis communication planning.
- Crisis communication planning and strategies:
    - Crisis communication team.
    - Developing crisis communication messages.
- Handling media and public relations during crises:
    - Media interviews and press releases.
    - Managing social media during a crisis.
- Maintaining transparency and trust in difficult situations:
    - Honesty and accountability.
    - Rebuilding trust post-crisis.
- Case studies of successful and unsuccessful crisis communication:
    - Analyzing real-world examples.

Unit 8: Communication in Leadership

- Leadership communication styles:
    - Authoritative, democratic, transformational, etc.
- Effective communication in management and leadership roles:
    - Leading by example.
    - Setting clear expectations.
- Building trust and credibility as a leader:
    - Open and honest communication.
    - Consistency in communication.
- Giving and receiving feedback:
    - Constructive feedback techniques.
    - Receiving feedback gracefully.
- Conflict resolution and negotiation skills for leaders:
    - Mediation and negotiation strategies.
    - Handling difficult conversations as a leader.

Unit 9: Specialized Communication Skills

- Interpersonal communication in personal relationships:
    - Family communication dynamics.

- Conflict resolution in personal relationships.
- Parent-child communication:
  - Effective communication with children.
  - Age-appropriate communication.
- Communication in healthcare settings:
  - Patient-provider communication.
  - Breaking bad news with empathy.
- Communication in legal and ethical contexts:
  - Ethical communication in law and ethics.
  - Attorney-client privilege.
- Effective communication in educational settings:
  - Classroom communication.
  - Teacher-student communication.
  - Parent-teacher conferences.
- Communication skills for sales and marketing:
  - Persuasive sales communication.
  - Building customer relationships.
  - Marketing message development.

Unit 10: Communication and Technology

- The impact of technology on communication:
  - Advantages and disadvantages.
  - Technological trends and their effects.
- Digital literacy and critical thinking in the digital age:
  - Evaluating online information.
  - Avoiding misinformation and disinformation.
- Cybersecurity and privacy in digital communication:
  - Protecting personal and professional information.
  - Safe online practices.
- Ethical considerations in online communication:
  - Online harassment and cyberbullying.
  - Ethical use of data and information.
- Navigating the challenges of misinformation and fake news:
  - Identifying credible sources.
  - Fact-checking techniques.
  - Media literacy.

Course Hours The course will have

- 120 hours for theory lectures per week

Reference:

Adler, R. B., & Elmhorst, J. M. (2021). Communication at Work: Principles and Practices for Business and the Professions. McGraw-Hill Education.

DeVito, J. A. (2020). The Interpersonal Communication Book. Pearson